

CRITERIA AND SELECTION OF SCHOOL AND CLASSROOM LIBRARY MATERIALS

Each school within Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) provides a variety of materials, resources, and equipment to support and enrich their respective instructional programs. This policy sets forth the relevant considerations surrounding the selection of school and classroom library materials.

A. School Libraries. Each school shall maintain a school library as the primary resource center of the school it serves and shall provide a unified program of media services and activities for students and teachers that supports the instructional program. The school library shall contain print and digital materials, and equipment that are generally sufficient to meet research, inquiry, and reading requirements of school instructional programs and general age-appropriate student interests.

1. Selection of School Library Materials. Library materials shall be selected by the library media specialist of each school in consultation with the principal or designee, appropriate teachers, and, if available, other specialized personnel, based on the following criteria:

- a. Maintain a collection of materials that meet or exceed the minimum standard of ten to twenty materials per student per the American Association of School Librarians.
- b. Maintain collections based on the academic programs, student use, and student population for the purpose of enriching and supporting the school curriculum and meeting the academic needs of the students and faculty served.
- c. Provide students with up-to-date, age-appropriate educational materials in a variety of accessible formats.
- d. Include materials that will allow students to develop as critical thinkers, through presenting multiple perspectives on controversial topics.
- e. Support a culturally responsive environment by including materials that are representative of all backgrounds within the LCPS community and beyond, as defined in Policy 1040 Equal Opportunity for Equitable, Safe, and Inclusive Environment.

B. Classroom Libraries. The purpose of the classroom library is to provide students with additional and consistent access to a wide range of reading material that encourages confident and independent readers.

1. While primary responsibility for the selection of materials in the classroom libraries rests with the classroom teacher, additional support may be provided by librarians, colleagues, and the content offices in the selection of such materials.

CRITERIA AND SELECTION OF SCHOOL AND CLASSROOM LIBRARY MATERIALS

2. Classroom libraries shall provide students with materials that will enrich and support the curriculum and meet the needs of the students served therein.

3. Classroom libraries will include materials that are representative of all backgrounds within the LCPS community and beyond, as defined in Policy 1040 Equal Opportunity for Equitable, Safe, and Inclusive Environment, to support a culturally responsive environment.

C. Retirement or Removal of Library Materials. School and classroom library materials, however acquired, will be retired/removed from the respective collection at the end of their useful life, as determined by professionally trained school library personnel, classroom teacher, or appropriate division personnel, and in accordance with the criteria set forth in this policy's accompanying regulation.

D. Prohibited Materials

1. Sexually Explicit Instructional Materials, as defined in Policy 5055 Parental Notification of Sexually Explicit Content, will not be made available in elementary school libraries or elementary classroom libraries.

2. School and classroom library collections shall not include materials that contain visual depictions of sexual conduct as defined in Policy 5055 Parental Notification of Sexually Explicit Content.

3. Materials that have been removed from circulation pursuant to the procedures outlined in Policy 5047 Review of Challenged Instructional & Library Materials will be prohibited unless access is expanded pursuant to Policy 5047.

E. Gifts and Donations. Gifts and donations of library materials to LCPS are welcome. Any gifts and/or donations that are not obtained through the standard selection and purchasing process shall be evaluated on the same criteria used for purchased materials.

F. Inventory. Each school library shall conduct a complete inventory of the books and other materials maintained by the library once every two years. No library should be closed to students and staff during the time the inventory is being conducted.

Adopted: 06/27/23

CRITERIA AND SELECTION OF SCHOOL
AND CLASSROOM LIBRARY MATERIALS

Cross Refs:

Policy [1040](#), Equal Opportunity for Equitable, Safe, and Inclusive Environment

Policy [5047](#), Review of Challenged Instructional & Library Materials

Policy [5055](#), Parental Notification of Sexually Explicit Content